

GLOBAL WELFARE FOUNDATION (GWF)

MONITORING, EVALUATION,

ACCOUNTABILITY & LEARNING (MEAL) PLAN

Integrated Community Development Programme
Kenya | January 2024 – December 2026

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1. Programme Overview

1.1 Background

Global Welfare Foundation (GWF) is implementing a three-year Integrated Community Development Programme in Kenya, with activities across five thematic sectors: Food Security, Education, Livelihoods, Health, and WASH & Environment. The programme is designed to address the interlocking drivers of poverty and vulnerability in target communities by delivering mutually reinforcing interventions across these sectors.

This Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) Plan sets out the systems, tools, processes, and responsibilities that govern how GWF will track progress, ensure data quality, maintain accountability to affected populations, and generate and apply learning throughout the programme.

1.2 Programme Objectives

The programme's overarching goal is to improve the well-being, resilience, and self-reliance of targeted communities. It pursues four Development Objectives:

- DO 1 — Health outcomes improved for women, children, and vulnerable groups
- DO 2 — Food security and nutrition status improved for targeted households
- DO 3 — Economic opportunities and livelihoods diversified for target households
- DO 4 — Education access and quality improved, with focus on girls' retention

1.3 Geographic and Beneficiary Scope

The programme operates in four counties in Kenya. Direct beneficiaries include an estimated 80,000 individuals across 16,000 households, with a deliberate focus on women-headed households, persons with disabilities, and out-of-school children. Indirect beneficiaries are estimated at 250,000 community members.

1.4 Programme Period

Implementation period: January 2024 – December 2026 (36 months)

Reporting cycle: Monthly (outputs), quarterly (outcomes), annual (impact-level)

Evaluations: Baseline (Q1 2024), Midline (Q2 2025), Endline (Q4 2026)

2. Theory of Change

2.1 Change Narrative

GWF's Theory of Change (ToC) posits that when chronically food-insecure, under-educated, and economically marginalised communities receive integrated, multi-sector support, they are better able to build resilience and break intergenerational cycles of poverty. The ToC rests on three core premises:

- Integrated interventions across sectors produce compounding and lasting impacts that siloed programming cannot achieve alone (e.g., combined food assistance, health outreach, and WASH improvements reduce child mortality more effectively than individual programmes).
- Empowering women and girls through education, cash transfers, and VSLA membership generates household-level and community-level multiplier effects on nutrition, savings, and child welfare.
- Investing in community systems — health promoters, farmer cooperatives, VSLAs, school management committees — creates sustainable service delivery and reduces dependency on external support.

2.2 Key Assumptions

The ToC is conditional on a number of assumptions that the MEAL system will actively monitor:

- Government systems (DHIS2, school EMIS, county offices) remain functional and accessible for data extraction.
- Communities are willing to participate in surveys, PDM visits, and feedback mechanisms without safety risk to enumerators.
- Seasonal and climate-related shocks do not overwhelm programme capacity. Contingency indicators flag this risk.
- Political stability is maintained across target counties; activities are adjusted as needed in consultation with the Protection team.
- Target households maintain programme engagement and do not relocate out of the programme area.

2.3 Results Framework

The programme is structured around a Goal — Development Objective — Intermediate Result (IR) — Output hierarchy. The full results framework, with indicators at each level, is presented in the Indicator Reference Sheet (Section 4). The hierarchy for the health sector is illustrative:

Goal: Improved well-being and resilience for targeted communities in Kenya

DO 1: Health outcomes improved for women, children, and vulnerable groups

IR 1.1: Access to quality health services increased

Sub-IR 1.1.1: Health facility capacity strengthened (# facilities meeting SARA standards)

Sub-IR 1.1.2: Essential medicine supply chains improved (stockout rate for tracer medicines)

IR 1.2: Health-seeking behaviors improved (EBF rate, ORS/zinc treatment coverage)

This hierarchy is replicated for each of the five sectors, providing a coherent chain of evidence from daily outputs to long-term impact.

3. M&E Framework and MEAL Structure

3.1 MEAL System Architecture

GWF's MEAL system operates on four interconnected pillars: Monitoring (real-time tracking of outputs and outcomes), Evaluation (periodic rigorous assessments), Accountability (feedback and complaint mechanisms for beneficiaries), and Learning (structured reflection and adaptation).

3.2 MEAL Staffing

The MEAL Officer is the technical lead for all four pillars. Reporting to the Programme Manager, the MEAL Officer works across all five sectors and is supported by two Field MEAL Assistants embedded in target counties. Programme Officers are responsible for primary data collection within their sectors, supervised by the MEAL Officer.

3.3 MEAL Calendar

Period	Activity	Responsible	Output
Monthly	Update IPTT with Output actuals from all sectors	Programme Officers	Updated IPTT
Monthly	Download and clean KoBoCollect data; sync to MIS	MEAL Officer	Cleaned dataset
Monthly	Review data quality; flag issues; back-check 10%	MEAL Officer	DQA log
Quarterly	Update Outcome indicators; run IPTT RAG analysis	MEAL Officer	Quarterly IPTT
Quarterly	Compile quarterly narrative report (programme + MEAL)	MEAL Officer + POs	Quarterly report
Quarterly	Conduct pause-and-reflect workshop with programme team	All programme staff	Learning notes
Quarterly	Review and update CFM log; analyze feedback trends	MEAL Officer	CFM report
Semi-annual	Submit donor progress report	Programme Manager + MEAL	Donor report
Semi-annual	WASH functionality and ODF verification checks	WASH Engineer	WASH report
Annual	Conduct PDM surveys (Food Security)	MEAL Officer + enumerators	PDM report
Annual	Submit Annual Programme Report	Programme Manager + MEAL	Annual report
Y1 Q1	Household baseline survey (all sectors)	MEAL Officer + surveying firm	Baseline report
Y2 Q2	Midline evaluation (independent)	Independent consultant	Midline report
Y3 Q4	Endline evaluation (independent)	Independent consultant	Endline report

4. Indicator Reference Sheet

The Indicator Reference Sheet (IRS) is the primary reference document for all performance indicators. It defines each indicator's measurement approach, disaggregation requirements, data source, and responsible person. The full IRS table below covers all 19 programme indicators across five sectors. For each indicator, a detailed definition and data collection procedure is maintained in the accompanying KoBoCollect forms.

ID	Indicator Name	Sector	Level	Unit	Baseline	LoP Target	Data Source	Frequency	Responsible
FS-01	% HHs with acceptable FCS (≥ 42)	Food Security	Outcome	%	38%	65%	HH survey	Quarterly	MEAL Officer
FS-02	% children 6-23m with minimum dietary diversity (MDD-W)	Food Security	Outcome	%	29%	55%	SMART nutrition survey	Semi-annual	MEAL/Nutrition
FS-03	# HHs receiving food assistance (cash/voucher/in-kind)	Food Security	Output	Number	0	12,000	Beneficiary database	Monthly	FS Officer
FS-04	# HHs receiving certified agricultural inputs	Food Security	Output	Number	0	8,500	Distribution registers	Per round	Agric. Officer
ED-01	% children (6-18) enrolled in formal/non-formal education	Education	Outcome	%	54%	80%	School EMIS; HH survey	Per term	Edu Officer
ED-02	% girls enrolled in secondary school (Grades 7-12)	Education	Outcome	%	41%	70%	School EMIS; MOE	Annual	Edu Officer
ED-03	# teachers trained in child-centred / inclusive pedagogy	Education	Output	Number	0	450	Training registers	Monthly	Edu Officer
ED-04	# students receiving learning materials	Education	Output	Number	0	25,000	Distribution registers	Per round	Edu Officer
LH-01	% target HHs reporting income increase from programme	Livelihoods	Outcome	%	0%	60%	Endline survey	Annual	LH Officer/MEAL
LH-02	# VSLAs established and functional	Livelihoods	Output	Number	0	120	VSLA monitoring forms	Monthly	LH Officer
LH-03	# persons trained in	Livelihoods	Output	Number (F/M)	0	3,200	Training registers	Monthly	LH Officer

ID	Indicator Name	Sector	Level	Unit	Baseline	LoP Target	Data Source	Frequency	Responsible
	vocational/business skills (F/M)								
LH-04	Value of cumulative VSLA savings mobilized (KES)	Livelihoods	Outcome	KES	KES 0	KES 48M	VSLA passbooks	Quarterly	LH/Finance
HH-01	% children U5 fully immunized (all antigens)	Health	Outcome	%	52%	80%	DHIS2; HH survey	Quarterly	Health Officer/MEAL
HH-02	% pregnant women completing ANC 4+ visits	Health	Outcome	%	48%	75%	DHIS2 HMIS	Quarterly	Health Officer
HH-03	# CHPs trained and deployed	Health	Output	Number (F/M)	0	320	Training registers	Monthly	Health Officer
WA-01	% target HHs with safe water (30-min round trip)	WASH & Env	Outcome	%	34%	70%	HH survey; WASH assessment	Semi-annual	WASH Officer/MEAL
WA-02	# functional water points constructed or rehabilitated	WASH & Env	Output	Number	0	85	Completion reports	Monthly	WASH Engineer
WA-03	% target communities verified Open Defecation Free (ODF)	WASH & Env	Outcome	%	12%	65%	CLTS verification reports	Quarterly	WASH Officer
WA-04	# hectares under active environmental restoration	WASH & Env	Output	Hectares	0	2,500	GPS site reports	Quarterly	Env. Officer

5. Data Collection and Management Plan

5.1 Primary Data Collection Tools

All primary data is collected using Kobo Toolbox / ODK, with forms developed and managed by the MEAL Officer. The following tools are in use across the programme:

Tool / Form	Sector	Data Collected	Platform	Frequency	Responsible	Stored In	Used For
Beneficiary Registration Form	All sectors	Individual & HH registration, GPS, demographics	Kobo Toolbox ODK	At enrolment	Programme Officers	GWF Beneficiary MIS	IPTT, deduplication, targeting
Distribution / Service Delivery Form	Food Security, Edu, Livelihoods	Transfers, quantities, attendance	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Each distribution event	Programme Officers	GWF Beneficiary MIS	Output tracking, IPTT
Post-Distribution Monitoring (PDM)	Food Security	FCS, HDDS, satisfaction	Kobo Toolbox ODK	After each distribution	MEAL Officer	Survey database	Output/outcome verification
Household Outcome Survey	All sectors	Outcome indicators, income, WASH access	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Baseline, midline, endline	MEAL Officer (supervised)	Survey database	Outcome IPTT, reports
VSLA Monitoring Form	Livelihoods	Meeting attendance, savings, loans	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Monthly per VSLA	LH Field Officers	VSLA tracker	LH-02, LH-04 IPTT
Training Attendance Form	All sectors	Participant details, pre/post test scores	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Each training	Programme Officers	Training database	ED-03, LH-03, HH-03 IPTT
WASH Facility Assessment	WASH & Env	Water point functionality, ODF status	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Monthly / per verification	WASH Engineer	WASH database	WA-01, WA-02, WA-03
DHIS2 Data Pull	Health	ANC, immunization, facility visits	DHIS2 (MOH)	Monthly extraction	Health Officer	Health database	HH-01, HH-02 IPTT
SMART Nutrition Survey	Food Security	MUAC, WHZ, MDD-W, IYCF	Kobo Toolbox ODK	Semi-annual	MEAL Officer + enumerators	Survey database	FS-02 IPTT

5.2 Beneficiary Database and MIS

GWF maintains a centralized beneficiary Management Information System (MIS) that serves as the single source of truth for beneficiary reach data. The MIS is built on a relational database with six core tables: beneficiary, household, programme_enrolment, service_delivery, monitoring_event, and programme.

- Beneficiaries are registered once at the point of enrolment, assigned a unique GWF ID, and linked to a household record with GPS coordinates.

- Service delivery events (distributions, trainings, health visits) are logged against beneficiary IDs, preventing double-counting across sectors.
- The IPTT workbook pulls directly from MIS extractions for Output indicators; Outcome indicators are sourced from periodic survey data.
- The MEAL Officer conducts a monthly MIS reconciliation to verify that KoBoCollect submissions have been uploaded and matched to beneficiary records.

5.3 Secondary Data Sources

Outcome indicators with governmental data sources are extracted on a regular schedule:

- DHIS2 (health): Monthly extraction by Health Officer. Data verified against facility registers quarterly.
- School EMIS (education): Extracted per school term. Verified against school-level head counts.
- SMART nutrition surveys: Conducted semi-annually by MEAL Officer with trained enumerators. Independent data entry and cleaning.
- County CLTS verification: Coordinated with county sanitation officers. GWF provides verification forms and supervises the process.

6. Data Quality Assurance (DQA)

6.1 DQA Principles

GWF's data quality standards are guided by five principles: Validity (indicators measure what they are intended to measure), Reliability (data collection is consistent across enumerators and time), Timeliness (data is submitted and cleaned within 48 hours of collection), Completeness (all required fields are captured), and Precision (data is accurate to the required level of detail).

6.2 DQA Procedures

Form-level controls (Kobo Toolbox)

- Mandatory fields: All core indicators set as required=yes in XLSForm; submission blocked until complete.
- Constraint validation: Range checks on numeric fields (e.g., FCS 0–112, age 0–120 months).
- Skip logic: Relevant clauses ensure enumerators only see applicable questions.
- GPS check: GPS coordinates auto captured for all registration and facility forms.
- Duplicate detection: Unique HH code required; system flags if code already exists in database.

Field-level controls

- Enumerator training: All data collectors trained for minimum 2 days per tool before deployment.
- Supervisor observation: Field MEAL Assistants observe 10% of interviews in first week of each survey.
- Back-checks: MEAL Officer conducts telephone back-checks on 10% of households per distribution.
- Daily data review: MEAL Officer reviews all submissions within 24 hours of collection; flags outliers.

Programme-level controls

- Monthly DQA meeting: MEAL Officer presents DQA log to Programme Manager. Issues tracked to resolution.
- Periodic data quality audits: External MEAL consultant conducts semi-annual audit of indicator data against source documents.
- Disaggregation checks: MEAL Officer verifies that female/male totals equal reported aggregate for all F/M indicators.

7. Accountability and Feedback Mechanism (CFM)

7.1 GWF Accountability Commitments

GWF is committed to the Core Humanitarian Standard (CHS) and the Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP) principles. All community members have the right to access information about the programme, provide feedback, and have complaints resolved fairly and promptly. GWF's Feedback Mechanism provides multiple, accessible channels for this engagement.

7.2 Feedback Channels

- Community feedback hotline: Toll-free number displayed at all distribution and project sites. Managed by MEAL Officer; responses within 5 working days.
- Suggestion boxes: Installed at all programme sites. Opened and logged weekly by Field MEAL Assistants.
- Community feedback meetings: Quarterly meetings in each programme ward. Facilitated by Field MEAL Assistants.
- Enumerator feedback capture: PDM and HH survey forms include a satisfaction and feedback module.
- Partner/staff reports: Programme Officers document community feedback during field visits.

7.3 CFM Case Management

All feedback is logged in the GWF CFM Register maintained by the MEAL Officer. Each entry is assigned a unique case number, categorized by type (information request, complaint, suggestion, compliment), and tracked to resolution.

Categories and response standards:

- Operational complaints (targeting errors, distribution problems): Resolution target 5 working days.
- Serious complaints (fraud, harassment, safeguarding): Escalated immediately to Programme Manager and HR; handled by GWF PSEA policy.
- Information requests: Response within 3 working days via callback or field visit.

A CFM trend analysis is included in each quarterly report. Key themes are raised in programme team meetings for adaptive management consideration.

7.4 Information Sharing

GWF commits to proactively sharing programme information with beneficiaries in accessible formats, including:

- Community information boards at all project sites (updated quarterly with programme objectives, eligibility criteria, and contact information).
- Village-level briefings before each distribution or activity cycle, conducted in local languages.
- Publication of summary programme results annually in community meetings.

8. Learning Agenda

8.1 Approach to Organizational Learning

GWF's learning approach is centered on the principle that evidence generated through monitoring and evaluation should actively inform programme design and decision-making. Learning is not a post-programme activity; it is embedded in routine programme management through structured pause-and-reflect events and a defined set of learning questions.

8.2 Learning Questions

The following strategic learning questions guide GWF's inquiry for this programme period. They were developed with programme staff and will be revisited at each annual review:

Learning Question	Sector	Method	When	Responsible	Intended Use
What factors most influence girls' school retention in target communities?	Education	FGDs with girls, teachers, parents	Y1 Q3 & Y2 Q3	Education Officer + MEAL	Adapt retention strategy, inform partners
Are cash transfers more effective than in-kind food assistance for improving FCS?	Food Security	Comparative PDM analysis + KII	After Y1 distributions	MEAL Officer	Adjust modality mix for Y2-Y3
What VSLA design features lead to highest savings retention?	Livelihoods	VSLA performance analysis + KII	Y1 Q4	Livelihoods Officer	Revise VSLA training curriculum
How do CHPs influence ANC attendance and immunization rates?	Health	CHP supervision data + facility records	Y2 Q2	Health Officer + MEAL	Adjust CHP deployment model
What WASH behaviors change after ODF verification?	WASH & Env	Before-after survey in ODF communities	6 months post-ODF	WASH Officer	Sustain ODF status protocols

8.3 Learning Cycle

Learning follows a structured four-stage cycle:

- **GENERATE:** Data collection and analysis through IPTT, surveys, PDM, and qualitative methods.
- **REFLECT:** Quarterly pause-and-reflect workshops with programme team. Annual learning event open to partners and communities.
- **DECIDE:** Management decisions documented in an Adaptive Management Log, with changes tracked against original programme design.
- **SHARE:** Learning products disseminated through GWF internal channels, donor reports, sector working groups, and case studies.

8.4 Adaptive Management

Where monitoring evidence identifies significant underperformance (RAG status 'Off Track' for two consecutive quarters), the MEAL Officer triggers a formal programme review with the following steps:

- Root cause analysis conducted with relevant Programme Officer.
- Adaptation options documented with cost and timeline implications.

- Decision and rationale recorded in the Adaptive Management Log.
- IPTT targets revised if required, with approval from Programme Manager and donor notification as appropriate.
- Follow-up monitoring at next reporting cycle to assess whether adaptation is achieving the desired change.

9. MEAL Staffing and Budget

9.1 MEAL Staffing

The MEAL function is staffed by the MEAL Officer (1.0 FTE, programme-level) and two Field MEAL Assistants (1.0 FTE each, county-level). The Programme Manager provides oversight. Programme Officers in each sector contribute approximately 15% FTE to data collection and reporting, coordinated and supervised by the MEAL Officer.

9.2 MEAL Budget Summary

The following budget covers all MEAL-related activities for the three-year programme. Staff costs represent the largest component. All figures are indicative and subject to annual review.

Activity	Description	Y1 (USD)	Y2 (USD)	Y3 (USD)	Total (USD)
MEAL Staff Costs	MEAL Officer (1 FTE), Field MEAL Assistants (2 FTE x 2 counties)	28,800	28,800	28,800	86,400
Baseline Survey	Full household survey (n=600), SMART nutrition survey	18,500	—	—	18,500
Midline Evaluation	Independent midline: household survey + KIIs	—	22,000	—	22,000
Endline Evaluation	Independent endline: household survey + FGDs	—	—	24,000	24,000
Kobo Toolbox / MIS Subscription	Kobo Toolbox Humanitarian account + MIS hosting	1,200	1,200	1,200	3,600
Data Collection Tools	Enumerator training, field tablets (8 units), airtime	8,400	2,400	2,400	13,200
PDM Surveys	3x PDM surveys/year after food distributions (food security)	3,600	3,600	3,600	10,800
Learning Events	Quarterly pause-and-reflect workshops, learning documentation	2,400	2,400	2,400	7,200
Accountability / CFM	Hotline, suggestion boxes, community feedback meetings	1,800	1,800	1,800	5,400
Reporting & Dissemination	Annual reports, case studies, donor reporting	3,200	3,200	3,200	9,600
Contingency (10%)	Unforeseen M&E costs	6,790	6,540	6,740	20,070
	TOTAL MEAL BUDGET	74,690	71,940	74,140	220,770

Annexes

Annex A — Data Collection Tools List

The following Kobo Toolbox / ODK forms have been developed and are available in the GWF KoBoToolbox Humanitarian account (project: GWF-Kenya-ICDP-2024):

- FORM-01 Beneficiary & Household Registration Form (beneficiary_registration_v1.0)
- FORM-02 Service Delivery / Distribution Form (service_delivery_v1.0)
- FORM-03 Post-Distribution Monitoring (PDM) Survey (pdm_survey_v1.0)
- FORM-04 Household Outcome Survey — Baseline/Midline/Endline (hh_outcome_survey_v1.0)
- FORM-05 VSLA Monthly Monitoring Form (vsla_monthly_v1.0)
- FORM-06 Training Attendance Form (training_attendance_v1.0)
- FORM-07 WASH Facility Assessment Form (wash_facility_v1.0)
- FORM-08 ODF Community Verification Form (odf_verification_v1.0)
- FORM-09 Environmental Restoration Site Monitoring Form (env_site_v1.0)
- FORM-10 CFM Intake and Case Management Form (cfm_intake_v1.0)

Annex B — Indicator Reference Sheet (Full Version)

The full Indicator Reference Sheet — including detailed definitions, disaggregation requirements, data quality notes, and collection procedures for each of the 19 programme indicators — is maintained in the accompanying GWF IPTT Excel workbook (GWF_IPTT_2024-2026.xlsx) and updated monthly by the MEAL Officer.

Annex C — Glossary

ANC: Antenatal care | CFM: Complaint and Feedback Mechanism | CHP: Community Health Promoter | CLTS: Community-Led Total Sanitation | DHIS2: District Health Information System version 2 | DQA: Data Quality Assurance | EMIS: Education Management Information System | FCS: Food Consumption Score | F/M: Female/Male disaggregation | HH: Household | IPTT: Indicator Performance Tracking Table | IRS: Indicator Reference Sheet | KII: Key Informant Interview | MDD-W: Minimum Dietary Diversity for Women | MIS: Management Information System | ODK: Open Data Kit | ODF: Open Defecation Free | PDM: Post-Distribution Monitoring | PSEA: Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse | RAG: Red-Amber-Green status | SMART: Standardized Monitoring and Assessment of Relief and Transitions | ToC: Theory of Change | VSLA: Village Savings and Loan Association | WASH: Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene